

EVIDENCE REPORT — UNIDENTIFIED CERAMIC OBJECT

PRELIMINARY ASSESSMENT. Artifact analysis pending. Full classification requires physical examination.

DESIGNATION	Unidentified Ceramic Object — Provisional designation: "Teacup" (Object of Interest: Macau)
PHYSICAL DESCRIPTION	A small stoneware drinking vessel, estimated 7 cm diameter × 5 cm height, approximate capacity 4 oz (118 ml). Material: stoneware ceramic with dark glaze on interior surface; exterior surface unglazed. A visible crack runs from rim to base — appears to be an old impact fracture, but the vessel has not fragmented further despite apparent age. The interior glaze is dark (tenmoku style, consistent with East Asian ceramic tradition). The exterior is rough, unglazed ceramic. The object is reportedly cold to the touch — consistently below ambient temperature per preliminary reports. This thermal anomaly is unconfirmed and requires verification.
PROVENANCE (PRELIMINARY)	Origin: East Asia, consistent with Chinese stoneware traditions. Estimated age: unknown — ceramic style suggests pre-modern origin (potentially Song dynasty or earlier, but this is visual assessment only; no laboratory dating has been conducted). The object reportedly surfaced in the Hong Kong antiquities market approximately six months ago. It is currently believed to be in Macau, possibly associated with a private sale or auction facilitated by a licensed antiquities dealer. Prior ownership history and archaeological context are unknown. The object does not appear in any reported stolen cultural property databases searched to date.

ANOMALOUS CHARACTERISTICS

Preliminary reports describe the object as consistently cold to the touch — below ambient temperature regardless of environmental conditions. This characteristic is anomalous for ceramic materials, which typically equilibrate with ambient temperature. The thermal anomaly has not been instrument-verified.

The object's physical integrity is noted: a visible crack runs from rim to base, yet the vessel has not fragmented. For a ceramic object of apparent age, this structural stability despite visible damage is unusual. The crack appears to be a single impact fracture with no propagation — ceramic materials with pre-existing cracks typically continue to fracture under thermal stress or handling. The object's resistance to further cracking is anomalous but may be explainable by material composition (analysis pending).

Additional anomalous characteristics may exist but have not been observed or reported. Physical examination is required for comprehensive assessment.

HANDLING ADVISORY

Recommendation: Do not handle the object without protective gloves. Exercise standard precautionary protocols for unidentified materials of unknown provenance. The object should be contained in a sealed, dry container if acquired.

The thermal anomaly — if confirmed — may indicate the object is not inert. Until physical examination can be conducted, the object should be treated as potentially hazardous. Do not use the object for its apparent function (as a drinking vessel). Do not introduce any substance into the object.

Advisory: This object has not been physically examined by qualified personnel. All characteristics described in this report are based on unverified preliminary reports. Treat with caution. Do not attempt independent testing. Await specialist analysis.

INVESTIGATION STATUS

The object is believed to be in Macau, possibly associated with a private antiquities transaction. The dealer, venue, buyers, and transaction structure are unknown and under active investigation. The object's presence in Macau is confirmed only by indirect indicators — financial activity patterns, travel records of persons of interest, and fragmentary market intelligence.

The object has not been physically located, examined, or verified. Its precise nature, origin, and characteristics are unknown. This report is a compilation of preliminary indicators only. Full assessment requires physical acquisition and specialist examination.